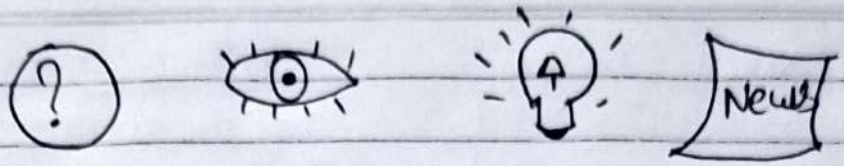
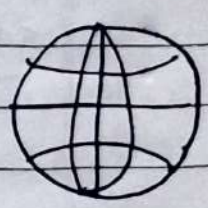
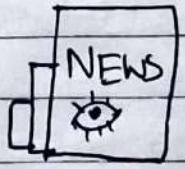


DAILY CURRENT AFFAIRS



24 July 2025 – 20 October 2025



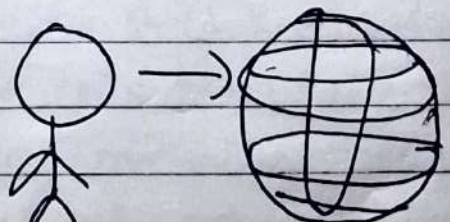
Daily important Current affairs

↓

policies, disasters, events, International relations

↓

Summary of significant recent events



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JULY 2025

28/07/25

DATE – 24 July 2025

Ending Manual Scavenging

Why in News?

A ministry of Social Justice study analyzed 54 hazardous cleaning deaths linked to manual scavenging (out of 150 nationwide) across 8 states/UTs during 2022-23.

Key Findings –

- Lack of Safety Gear – In 90% of cases (49 out of 54), no safety equipment was provided.

  Rest → Minimal protection → gloves (in 5 cases)
  → gloves with gumboots (1 case)

- Most deaths occurred in the absence of mechanized equipments such as suction pumps or robotic cleaners.

- Institutional Negligence – In most cases, agencies lacked

equipment readiness and awareness drives were either absent or incomplete.

- No Informed consent - Entered sewers without consent
  Not informed of associated risks.

- Exploitative Hiring practices - Hired informally on individual contracts.

  Few as direct government or outsourced PSU employees.

What is Manual Scavenging and Legal Framework -

* It refers to the practice of manually handling or cleaning human excreta, often from insanitary toilets, open drains, pits or railway tracks.

Current Status - According to Govt. it has officially ended

Current Challenge → Hazardous cleaning of sewers and septic tanks.

- The NAMASTE Scheme has identified 84,902 sewer and septic tank workers across 36 states and union territories

NAMASTE Scheme → National Action for Mechanised Sanitation Ecosystem

* Promotes formation of ~~formation~~ and strengthening of self-help groups (SHGs) among sanitation workers.

- Violation of fundamental rights – It violates fundamental rights particularly –

Article 17 (abolition of untouchability), Article 21 (right to life with dignity)

- Legal framework –

1. Prohibition of Employment as Manual Scavengers and their rehabilitation Act, 2013 (PEMSR)

prohibits any individual manually handling human excreta until its disposal

* Manual scavenging → dehumanizing practice

2. SC/ST (prevention of atrocities) Act, 1989 –

Criminalizes employment of scheduled castes in scavenging.

3. Supreme Court (SC) guidelines -

Dr. Balram Singh v Union of India (2023)

SC directed union and state govt. to eliminate manual scavenging and hazardous cleaning.

Guidelines -

i) Rehabilitation - Rs 30 lakh for deaths, Rs 10-20 lakh for disabilities plus jobs for kin and education for dependents.

ii) NALSA - Oversee compensation disbursement.
↓
National Legal Service Authority

iii) Transparency - Launch of dedicated portal for tracking deaths, compensation, rehabilitation.

Self Employment Scheme for Rehabilitation of Manual Scavengers (SRMS)
↓
Health insurance under Ayushman Bharat - PMJAY,

Skill development training

Portal for this is → nskfdc.nic.in

(National Safai Karamcharis Finance and Development Corporation)

NCSK - National Commision for Safai Karamcharis → August 1994. (ncsk.nic.in)
↓
Made under NCSK Act, 1993 → National Commission for Safai Karamcharis Act

NCSC → National Commission for Scheduled Castes (ncsc.nic.in)

NCST → National Commission for Scheduled Tribes (ncst.nic.in)

* nic.in → National Informatics Center
↓
Ministry of Electronics and Information technology (Meity)
↓
Technology partner of Govt. of India
↓
GI Cloud (Govt. of India Cloud Computing Initiative)
↓
MeghRaj → (Cloud) → February 2014

Services → PaaS, SaaS, IaaS, Virtual Servers, Kubernetes, DevOps etc.

Jio → Cloud manage platforms → ₹ 3.5 billion (US $ 41 million) Deal, April 2023
↓
Manage and improve cloud services

Bharat Maps → Web mapping service
↓
2004 - 09 (five year cycle)
↓
Data from → Survey of India, Registrar general of India, Indian Space Research Organization (ISRO)

Challenges faced by Manual Scavengers -

- Health risks - Toxic gas exposure → hydrogen sulphide
  Hepatitis, Tetanus, Cholera, Asphyxiation
- Social stigma - Caste-based discrimination
- Economic challenges - paid below minimum wage
  contractual / daily wage basis
- Double discrimination - Gender-based discrimination, sexual assault, abuse!

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18/09/25

DATE - 18 SEPTEMBER 2025

CSC achieves ₹3000 Crore loan disbursal -

Under digital India, Benefitting 70000 underserved borrowers

RBI unveils microsite showcasing Banknote design and Security elements -

at https://indiancurrency.rbi.org.in

₹10 → 2018, Chocolate Brown Colour, Design Motif - Sun Temple Konark (at Back of Note)

₹20 → 2019, Greenish yellow, Ellora Caves

₹50 → 2017, Fluorescent Blue, Hampi with Chariots

₹100 → 2018, Lavender, Rani ki Vav or Queen's Stepwell

₹200 → 2017, Bright yellow, Sanchi Stupa

₹500 → 2016, Stone Grey, Red fort

₹2000 → 2016, Magenta, Mangalyaan Motif

DAILY CURRENT AFFAIRS

Policies, Disasters, International Relations

↓

Summary of Significant recent events

21 OCTOBER 2025 - 31 MARCH 2026

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OCTOBER 2025

21/10/25

DATE - 21 OCTOBER 2025

NITI Aayog's Women Entrepreneurship platform and DP world launch 'We Rise' -

Under WEP's Award to Reward (ATR)

Akkai Padmashali named first transgender representative from Karnataka -

tasked with formulating an equal opportunity policy for the protection of transgender rights, Supreme Court appointed Committee

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DATE - 05 JANUARY 2026

ADB Sanctions ₹4100 Crore loan -

to Telangana for Musi Riverfront Development project

Kaamya Karthikeyan become youngest female to scale seven summits -

Highest peaks on all seven Continents (called summits) - (summit → Top, peak or highest level)

	Continent	Peak	Height	Country
1.	Asia	Mount Everest	8848.86 m	Nepal / China (Tibet)
2.	South America	Aconcagua	6961 m	Argentina
3.	North America	Denali (McKinley)	6190 m	US
4.	Africa	Mount Kilimanjaro	5895 m	Tanzania
5.	Europe	Mount Elbrus	5642 m	Russia
6.	Antarctica	Mount Vinson	4892 m	No country
7.	Australia / Oceania	Mount Kosciuszko	2228 m	Australia

06/01/26 DATE - 06 JANUARY 2026

India UPI Records 21.63 billion transactions -

in Dec 25 : NPCI

Indian Oil Corporation Sources first Crude Oil Cargo -

from Colombia to reduce dependence on Russian Supplies